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Shisa City Community Kitchen

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1) Organisation Overview

Name: Shisa City Community Kitchen

History: The **Shisa City Community Kitchen** is a recent initiative that emerged from the efforts of philanthropists concerned about the growing number of needy families in the city's eastern region. It all started in 2015 as a humble soup kitchen that provided free meals every week in the local church. However, the **Shisa City Community Kitchen** has been a program for ten years. It has grown from being just a soup kitchen to a community kitchen with a commercial kitchen, a community hall, and a small kitchen garden. Currently, more than 500 meals are provided weekly, along with several cooking classes, some literacy classes, and other services that address social service needs while promoting food security.

Mission Statement: To feed our communities by supplying healthy, affordable food while creating connections and food skills among the community.

Vision Statement: A community that has access to nutritious food and the skills to prepare it, protecting integrity, connections, and wellbeing.

Target audience: The website is designed for three types of users:

- **Service Users:** Those with low income, the elderly, students, and new migrants who need help.
- **Donors and Supporters:** People and companies that are determined to donate to the cause.
- **Volunteers:** People who have the time to do volunteer activities like working in the kitchen, gardening, and financial tasks.

2) Website goals and objectives

Specific Goals:

- Increase the quantity of volunteers by 30 percent throughout the first half of the year following the launch.
- Raise the amount of monthly donations by 25 percent through simplifying the process for online giving.
- Reduce the time spent by employees on phone calls by forty percent by providing self-service options for information.
- Increase awareness of the organization's programs and impact in the community.

Key performance indicators:

- The number of applications for every month
- Conversion rate and value of monthly online donations
- Hits for program pages
- The decrease in phone calls about hours, the location, and services provided
- Growth in newsletter sign-ups

3) Current website analysis

Strengths:

- The current website provides basic contact information, operating hours, and a description
- Clean and accessible layout with readable fonts
- Simple navigation structure throughout the website

Weaknesses:

- No online giving option (donors have to call or come into the office)
- Old content that hasn't been updated in over 18 months
- Lacks an events calendar for community programs and classes.

Areas for improvement:

- Add volunteer application forms with automated confirmation
- Create dynamic content sections for program updates and success stories
- Build an events calendar with registration functionality
- Implement secure online donation processing. Add volunteer application forms with automated confirmation.

4) Proposed website features and functionality

- **Homepage:** Attractive headline of the mission of our organization, impact of our work, and clear calls to action (donate, volunteer, learn more)
- **About Us:** Our story/history, team bios, annual reports, impact stories
- **Our Programs:** Details on our Meal Programs, Cooking Classes, and Food Literacy Programs, including schedules and eligibility.
- **News & events:** Blogs or news and events calendar
- **Resources:** Connections to other community food services, government resources, and food literacy
- **Contact:** location map with public transport information and emergency contact details

5) Design and user experience

Colour scheme: Warm, inviting palette reflecting the organisation's community

focus:

- **Orange** – warmth and nourishment
- **Green** – the food garden and healthy eating
- **Cream** – welcoming, approachable feeling
- **Charcoal** – text and structure

Typography:

- Headings: Lato – clean and readable
- Body text: Open Sans – excellent legibility
- Hierarchy: differentiation on size, weight and colour contrast

Layout and design:

- Use of clean, minimalist design and lots of white space to reduce eye-candy and focus on the essential
- Group information related to the program and the news into cards, making it easy to scan through
- Make calls-to-action text stand out by using contrasting colours
- Images of the kitchen, the garden and the people captured at high quality.

User experience consideration:

- It is easy to use, with intuitive navigation and informative labels
- Simple and slick design that makes it easy to find what you need
- Looks good on different types of devices, from phones to desktops
- Built with accessibility in mind

Low-fidelity wireframes:

- Homepage layout with hero section, impact stats, program highlights, and calls-to-action

- Get Involved page showing volunteer opportunities and application form layout
- Donate page illustrating the donation flow and form structure

6) Technical requirements

Hosting and Domain:

- Domain: shisacitycommunitykitchen.org.za
- Hosting: Mutual hosting plan with SSL certificate for secure transactions

Technologies:

- HTML5 for semantically structured
- CSS3 with Flexbox and Grid for responsive layout
- JavaScript for interactive elements
- A simple PHP for form handling
- YOCO for payment processing

7) Timeline and Milestones

Milestone	Duration	Target Date
Discovering and requirements gathering	2 Weeks	28 September 2016
Design phase	3 Weeks	19 October 2016
Front-end development	4 Weeks	16 November 2016
Back-end integration	3 Weeks	7 December 2016
Testing and quality assurance	2 Weeks	21 December 2016
Launch and training	1 Week	28 December 2016

8) Budget

Item	Cost
Domain Registration	R650
Web Hosting	R3900
Development Costs	R56 700
Content Creation	R8100
Maintenance	R9700
Total:	R79050

9) References

- Burke, G. (2025). "LocalConnect: Designing Community-Centered Digital Solutions for Small-Scale Retail Sustainability." IEEE Xplore.
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